

Winding Tree's CEO Maksim Izmaylov says that Hobo Hotel Stockholm, a member of the Nordic Choice Hotels group, was the first hotel to undertake hotel booking and reservation services using their latest blockchain technology to provide real-life use case and best-in-class services to their customers in the travel and hospitality space without charging commission fees. As the platform is open source and distributed, it generates boundless possibilities for customers who are looking for lower costs, security, connectivity, and unlimited innovation opportunities. The hotel can choose to accept payments in the form of fiat, credit card, or cryptocurrency (only Lif token or Ether).

Airport Hotel Basel (Switzerland) chain and citizenM Hotel (Malaysia) chain have understood the outstanding benefits of blockchain and hence signed a partnership with Winding Tree not only to foster innovation in the hospitality industry but also to exchange data and transact in a more straightforward, efficient, and transparent way that gets rid of middlemen and associated fees. Winding Tree is not only for giant hotels but even for small hotels, and start-ups who wish to avail the benefits.

Cool Cousin is a decentralised travel agency that has integrated the emerging blockchain technology to expand its business worldwide with the help of local experts in each city. These locals are known as 'Cousins' who love to share enough information about their city. Cool Cousin was set in motion with its curated travel experience during 2016 as a 16-person start-up, and today 500,000 travellers make use of it. Travellers can download this app in their mobile and

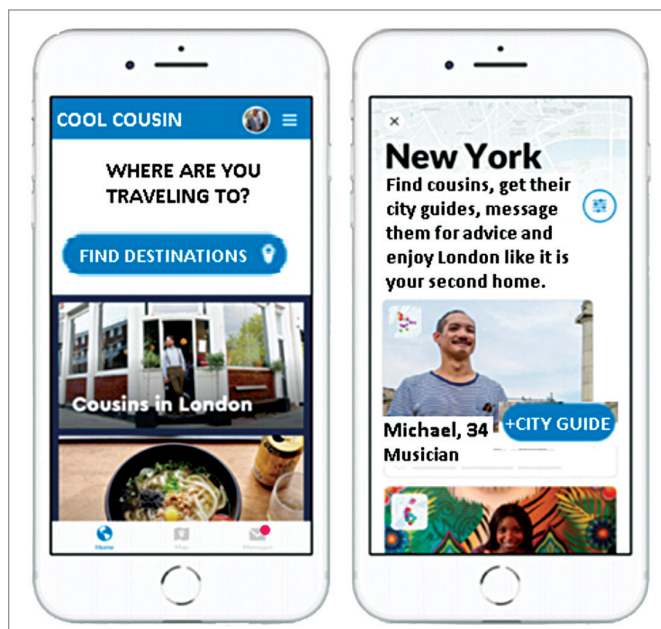


Figure 3: Cool Cousin mobile app

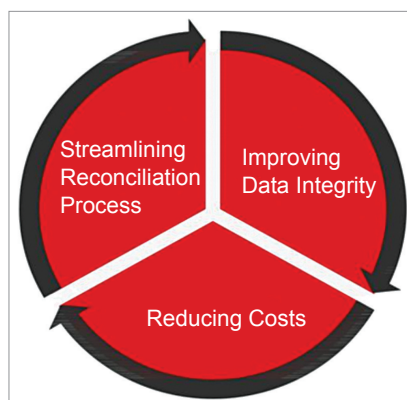


Figure 4: Efficiency of Rezchain (Image credit: Webbeds)

book services, find places of interest, get a ride from Uber, or use any other app-driven service. It uses the cryptocurrency called CUZ.

Members of Cool Cousin are issued utility tokens that grant them permission to participate in their platform and get access to various services provided. As many people are not aware of the cryptocurrency, Cool Cousin accepts fiat currencies but converts them to CUZ tokens behind the scenes. The tokenised smart contracts make the service more trustworthy and efficient for a small transaction fee.

Webjet uses Ethereum on Microsoft Azure for strengthening the data reconciliation service called Rezchain, which is a new technology that enables error-free hotel bookings in real time. Sometimes when bookings are done, discrepancies occur in price, duration of stay, booking status, currency, or room type, leading to invoice disputes between relevant parties. Rezchain warns the parties involved to verify if their reservation data matches with the booking systems, so that it can be fixed early in the booking process. For example,

if one side assumes the booking has been cancelled and the other side assumes that the booking is done in their system, Rezchain alarms both the parties, thus making invoicing almost seamless with minimum friction and more efficient. Webjet has travel partners in Europe, Indonesia, China, Southeast Asia, Middle East Africa, North and South America.

ITC Hotels, the third-largest Indian hotel chain, have proved their commitment to a safe world by using VeChainThor blockchain together with DNV GL's (Det Norske Veritas, Norway and Germanischer Lloyd, Germany) My Care methodology to assist Covid-19 infection risk management for their visitors. VeChain blockchain is the first 5-star rated blockchain service provider in the world! Visitors can scan the My Care QR code online or at the hotel premises and complete the DNV GL's Covid-19 guidance document. The document guides the visitors in a consumer-friendly way. Each visitor's details and the DNV GL's rating statement are stored by the VeChain blockchain. Thus, ITC